MEASURE "M" - MURRIETA VALLEY UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

FULL TEXT OF BOND MEASURE

MURRIETA VALLEY UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT — SCHOOL IMPROVEMENT BOND OF 2026

By approval of this measure by at least fifty-five percent (55%) of the registered voters voting thereon, the Murrieta Valley Unified School District shall be authorized to issue and sell bonds of up to $359,000,000 in aggregate principal amount to provide financing for the specific school facilities projects listed below in the Bond Project List, subject to all of the accountability safeguards specified herein.

SECTION I: KEY FINDINGS

- Murrieta Valley Unified School District ("District") provides an excellent education for local students and local schools consistently rank among the best in the County and State, which is consistent with its mission to provide District students with the knowledge to recognize their significance and potential.
- While the District strives to meet the needs of our community and students, many neighborhood schools are now more than 30 years old, with classrooms and science labs that have seen little to no modernization and were built for a different area of education.
- This past year, the District recorded over 125 roof leaks, and the aging air-conditioning systems—many older than 25 years—are increasingly unable to keep up during extreme heat.
- Currently, students attend classes in more than 150 portable classrooms that are over 20 years old. Many of these classrooms suffer from water leaks, structural damage, and other ongoing maintenance challenges
- Over the past year, the District has conducted and completed a comprehensive, transparent, long-term community Facilities Master Plan that identified the needs at each school site to meet modern safety and security standards, meet the District's goals for supporting current academic standards, and address specific priorities at individual school sites.
- Bond revenue is the primary means by which all school districts are able to keep their school buildings and classrooms in good repair, safe, designed and equipped to support changing educational standards, methods and approaches.
- The District cannot rely on the State of California to fund school facility improvements and the limited state dollars available for facility upgrades often require local matching funds that could be provided by a local bond measure.
- This bond measure requires strict fiscal accountability protections including mandatory annual audits and an independent citizens' oversight committee comprised of local residents to ensure funds are managed and spent properly.
- The Board pledges to issue bonds under the measure in a fiscally responsible manner that protects local taxpayers. The District will issue new voter-approved general obligation bonds only if the tax rate to repay them replaces, rather than increases, the existing bond tax rate, with the expectation that the combined District bond tax rate will decrease over time as prior bonds are paid down or retired.

SECTION II: ACCOUNTABILITY MEASURES

The provisions in this section are included in this proposition in order that the voters and taxpayers of the District may be assured that their money will be spent to address specific facilities needs of the District, all in compliance with the requirements of Article XIII A, section 1(b)(3) of the State Constitution, and the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bonds Act of 2000 (codified at Section 15264 *et seq.* of the California Education Code).

Evaluation of Needs. The Board of Education of the District (the "Board") has evaluated the facilities needs of the District and has identified projects to finance from a local bond measure at this time. The Board has certified that it has evaluated safety, class size reduction and information technology needs in developing the Bond Project List.

Independent Citizens' Oversight Committee. The Board shall appoint a new or empower an existing independent Citizens' Oversight Committee in accordance with Education Code sections 15278-15282 and applicable Board policy, to ensure bond proceeds are expended only for the school facilities projects listed in the Bond Project List. The committee shall be established within sixty (60) days of the date when the Board enters the results of the election in its official minutes.

Annual Performance Audit. The Board shall conduct or cause to be conducted an annual, independent performance audit to ensure that the bond proceeds have been expended only on the school facilities projects described in the Bond Project List.

Annual Financial Audit. The Board shall conduct or cause to be conducted an annual, independent financial audit of the bond proceeds until all of those proceeds have been spent.

Annual Report to Board. Upon approval of this measure and the sale of any bonds approved, the Board shall take actions necessary to establish an account in which proceeds of the sale of bonds will be deposited. As long as any proceeds of the bonds remain unexpended, the Superintendent shall cause a report to be filed with the Board no later than January 1 of each year, commencing on the first January 1 after bonds have been issued and proceeds spent, stating (1) the amount of bond proceeds received and expended in the past fiscal year, and (2) the status of

any project funded or to be funded from bond proceeds. The report may be incorporated into the annual budget, annual financial report, or other appropriate routine report to the Board.

SECTION III: BOND PROJECT LIST

Murrieta Valley Unified School District Bond Project List

The Bond Project List below lists the specific projects the District proposes to finance with proceeds of the bonds. The Bond Project List shall be considered a part of this bond measure and shall be reproduced in any official document required to contain the full statement of the bond measure. In so far as permitted by law, each project is assumed to include its share of construction-related costs, such as project and construction management, architectural, engineering, permitting and entitlements, inspection and similar planning and testing costs, demolition and interim facility costs, furnishing and equipping spaces, legal, accounting and similar fees, costs related to the independent annual financial and performance audits, a contingency for unforeseen design and construction costs, and other costs incidental to or necessary for completion of the listed projects (whether the related work is performed by the District or third parties). The final cost of each project will be determined as plans are finalized, construction bids are awarded, and projects are completed. In addition, certain project funds expected from non-local bond sources, including State of California grant funds for eligible projects, have not yet been secured. Therefore, the Board cannot guarantee that the bond proceeds will provide sufficient funds to allow completion of all listed projects. Alternatively, if the District obtains unexpected funds from non-local bond sources with respect to listed projects, such projects may be enhanced, supplemented or expanded to the extent of such funds. Some projects may be subject to further government approvals, including by State officials and boards and/or local environmental or agency approval. Inclusion of a project on the Bond Project List is not a guarantee that the project will be completed (regardless of whether bond funds are available)

The specific projects authorized to be financed with proceeds from the sale of bonds authorized by this measure are as follows:

ELEMENTARY SCHOOL PROJECTS

Alta Murrieta Elementary - Originally Built in 1989

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Classroom Building
- Modernization of Outdoor Amphitheater to include with shade elements
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off Area
- Modernization of Playground Equipment including Surfacing and Shade
- Modernization of Athletic Fields and Facilities including Hardcourt Improvements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades, including campus access, fencing and security systems
- Replace Solar Panels

Antelope Hills Elementary - Originally built in 2005

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Classroom Buildings
- Modernization of Playground Equipment including Safety Surfacing and Shade
- Modernization of MPR, including AV and New Digital Marquee
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off Area
- Replace Solar Panels and Add Battery Backup

Avaxat Elementary School - Originally built in 1987

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Classroom Buildings
- New Multi-Purpose Room and/or Food Services Facility
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- New Kindergarten Play Area
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade, Improve and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off Area
- Replace Solar Panels

Buchanan Elementary School - Originally built in 2001

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Classroom Buildings
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- Upgrade, Improve and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off Area
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements
- New Multi-Use Student Pavilion
- Replace Solar Panels and add Battery Backup

Cole Canyon Elementary School - Originally built in 2000

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Classroom Buildings and New Parking Lot
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- New Multi-Use Student Pavilion
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Replace Solar Panels

E. Hale Curran Elementary School - Originally built in 1989

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Classroom Buildings and New Parking Lot
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- New Multi-Use Student Pavilion
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Replace Solar Panels

Lisa J. Mails Elementary School - Originally built in 2008

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Classroom Buildings
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements and field lighting
- Modernization of Outdoor Amphitheater to include shade elements
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking Lot and/or Drop Off
- Replace Solar Panels

Monte Vista Elementary School - Originally built in 2003

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Classroom Buildings
- New Multi-Use Student Pavilion
- Administration Building Reconfiguration
- New Food Service Building
- New Student Restrooms
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking Lot and/or Drop Off
- Replace Solar Panels

Murrieta Elementary School - Originally built in 1958

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Classroom Building
- New Multi-Use Student Pavilion
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements with Field Lighting
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Restroom Building
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Replace Solar Panels and Battery Backup

Rail Ranch Elementary School - Originally built in 1989

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Classroom Building
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- Modernization of Playground Equipment with Safety Surfacing and Shade
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements with Field Lighting
- Upgrade Parking and Drop-Off to include New Shade Elements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Replace Solar Panels and Battery Backup

Tovashal Elementary School - Originally built in 1996

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- New Classroom Buildings
- Modernization of Athletic Fields & Hardcourt Improvements with Field Lighting
- New Lunch Shelter
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade Parking and Drop-Off Improvements to include New Shade Elements
- Replace Solar Panels

MIDDLE SCHOOL PROJECTS

Dorothy McElhinney Middle School - Originally built in 2009

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Modernization of Athletic Fields with Field Lighting, Hardcourt Improvements and New Bathrooms
- New Performing Arts Center
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off
- Replace Solar Panels

Shivela Middle School - Originally built in 1990

- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- New Classroom Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Gym with air conditioning
- Modernization of Athletic Fields with Field Lighting, Hardcourt improvements with New Restrooms
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Replace Solar Panels

Thompson Middle School - Originally built in 1994

- Modernization of Existing Buildings including a CTE expansion
- New Classroom Building
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Gym and air-conditioning
- Removal of Aging Portable Classroom
- Acquire and Construct new Classroom Buildings
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off
- Replace Solar Panels

Warm Springs Middle School - Originally built in 2002

- Modernization of Existing Buildings including a CTE expansion
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Modernization of Athletic Fields with Field Lighting, Hardcourt Improvements with New Restrooms
- Add air-conditioning to existing gym
- Upgrade and/or Expand Parking and Drop-Off
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology Replace Solar Panels

HIGH SCHOOL PROJECTS

Murrieta Mesa High School - Originally built in 2009

- Modernization of Existing Buildings including a CTE expansion
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New CTE Building
- Modernization of Athletic Fields with Field Lighting, Hardcourt Improvements
- New Locker Rooms and Concessions
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Replace Solar Panels

Murrieta Valley High School - Originally built in 1990

- Modernization of Existing Science and 700 Building Specialty Classrooms
- New CTE Building
- Modernization of Existing Buildings including a CTE expansion
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- New Building that includes Competition Gym, Auxiliary Gym, Lockers Rooms; Team Rooms, Weight Room, Dance Room, Wrestling Room Fitness and/or P.E. Rooms
- Convert Existing Administration Building to Multi-Purpose Room
- New Administration Building
- Modernization of Athletic Fields with Field Lighting & Hardcourt Improvements
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- New Media Classroom Building
- New Staff and Student Restrooms
- Parking Lot and/or Drop-Off Improvements
- Replace Solar Panels

Vista Murrieta High School - Originally built in 2003

- New CTE Building
- Modernization of Existing Buildings including a CTE expansion
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Modernization of Athletic Fields with Field Lighting & Hardcourt Improvements
- Removal of Aging Portable Classrooms
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Parking Lot and/or Drop-Off Improvements
- New Band Room and Dance Room
- New Weight Room with Outdoor Shaded Area
- Replace Solar Panels

Murrieta Canyon Academy - Originally built in 1998

- New CTE Building
- Modernization of Existing Buildings
- Acquisition, installation and construction of shaded outdoor learning spaces
- Fire/Life Safety and Security upgrades to include campus access, fencing and security system technology
- Parking Lot and/or Drop Off Improvements
- New Administration Building
- Replace Solar Panels

ALL SITES

- Upgrade, renovate, and/or replace major building systems; includes cooling, heating, ventilation, lighting, electrical, plumbing, irrigation, drainage, elevator, sewer and gas.
- Repair, replace and/or upgrade building exterior and weather protection systems, including roofs, gutters, downspouts, doors, windows, and exterior paint.
- Renovate, repair, resurface, upgrade, expand, construct and or install and improve paved and other hard surfaces, playgrounds, playfields and landscaping.

MISCELLANEOUS

All listed bond projects include the following as needed and may be completed at all District sites:

- Planning and designing necessary for specific, approved bond projects.
- The inspection, sampling and analysis of grounds, buildings and building materials to determine the presence of hazardous materials or substances, including asbestos, lead, etc., and the encapsulation, removal, disposal and other remediation or control of such hazardous materials and substances.
- Seismic and historical evaluations, site surveys (including topographic, geological and utility surveys), and infrastructure analyses.
- Necessary onsite and offsite preparation or restoration in connection with new construction, renovation or remodeling, or installation or removal of relocatable buildings or other temporary buildings, including demolition of structures; removing, replacing, or installing irrigation, drainage, utility lines (gas, water, sewer, electrical, data and voice, etc.), trees and landscaping; and relocating fire access roads or ingress/egress pathways.
- Address other unforeseen conditions revealed by construction, renovation or improvements (including plumbing or gas line breaks, dry rot, seismic and structural deficiencies, etc.).
- Acquire or construct other improvements required to comply with building codes, including seismic safety requirements, the Field Act, and access requirements.
- Acquisition of any rights-of-way, easements, licenses and/or real property made necessary by listed bond projects, or lease of real property made necessary by the listed bond projects.
- Acquire or construct storage facilities and other space on an interim basis, as needed to accommodate construction materials, equipment, and personnel.
- Initial furnishing and equipping of classrooms and other school facilities.
- All other costs and work necessary or incidental for the specific, approved bond projects.

PROJECTS INVOLVING RENOVATION, REHABILITATION OR REPAIR

For any project involving renovation, rehabilitation, repair, or upgrade of a building or the major portion of a building (including seismic repairs), the District shall be authorized to proceed with new replacement construction instead (including any necessary demolition) if the Board determines that replacement new construction is more practical than renovation, rehabilitation, repair, or upgrade, considering the building's age, condition, expected remaining life, comparative cost and other relevant factors.

SECTION IV: ADDITIONAL SPECIFICATIONS

No Operating Expenses. Proceeds from the sale of Bonds authorized by this proposition shall be used only for the construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation or replacement of school facilities on the Bond Project List, including the furnishing and equipping of said school facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for said school facilities, and not for any other purpose, including teacher or administrator salaries and other school operating expenses in accordance with applicable law.

Single Purpose. All of the purposes enumerated in this proposition shall be united and voted upon as one single proposition, pursuant to Section 15100 of the California Education Code, and all the enumerated purposes shall constitute the specific single purpose of the bonds and proceeds of the bonds shall be spent only for such purpose.

Other Terms of the Bonds. The bonds may be issued and sold in several series, and in accordance with a financing plan determined by the Board pursuant to requirements of law. When sold, the bonds shall bear interest at an annual rate not exceeding the statutory maximum and with a maximum term not exceeding the statutory maximum, provided that the average useful life of bonds sold will not exceed one hundred twenty percent (120%) of the average life of the projects being financed or as otherwise provided by federal tax law. Bond funds may be used to reimburse the District for Bond Project list expenditures incurred prior to the election and bond issuance, in accordance with federal tax law.

Attention of all voters is directed to the fact that the financial information contained in this measure is based upon the District's projections and estimates only, which are not binding upon the District, nor are the summary or average payment estimates, if any, provided in the Ballot Label. The actual tax rates, debt service and the years in which they will apply may vary from those presently estimated, due to variations from these estimates in the timing of bond sales, the amount of bonds sold and market interest rates at the time of each sale, and actual assessed valuations over the term of repayment of the bonds. The dates of sale and the amount of bonds sold at any given time will be determined by the District based on need for construction funds and other factors. The actual interest rates at which the bonds will be sold will depend on the bond market at the time of each sale. Actual future assessed valuation will depend upon the amount and value of taxable property within the District as determined by the County Assessor in the annual assessment and the equalization process.

In preparing this information, the District obtained reasonable and informed projections of assessed property valuations that took into consideration projections of assessed property valuations made by the County Assessor, if any, in accordance with Education Code Section 15100(c).

State Matching Funds - Education Code 15122.5

Approval of Measure M does not guarantee that the proposed project or projects in the Murrieta Valley Unified School District that are the subject of bonds under Measure M will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by Measure M. The school district's proposal for the project or projects may assume the receipt of matching state funds, which could be subject to appropriation by the Legislature or approval of a statewide bond measure.

MEASURE "M" - MURRIETA VALLEY UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

TAX RATE STATEMENT

An election will be held within the boundaries of Murrieta Valley Unified School District ("District") on November 3, 2026 to authorize the sale of up to $359 million in bonds to finance facilities as described in the measure. If the bonds are approved, the District expects to sell the bonds in multiple series. Principal and interest on the bonds will be payable from the proceeds of tax levies made upon the taxable property located within the District. The following information is provided in compliance with Sections 9400 to 9404, inclusive, of the California Elections Code.

1. The best estimate from official sources of the average annual tax rate that would be required to be levied to fund this bond issue over the entire duration of the bond debt service, based on assessed valuations available at the time of the election and a projection based on experience within the same jurisdiction and other demonstrable factors, is estimated to be $49.64 per $100,000 of assessed valuation. The final fiscal year in which the tax is anticipated to be collected is 2058-59.

2. The best estimate from official sources of the highest tax rate that would be required to be levied to fund this bond issue, and an estimate of the year in which that rate will apply, based on assessed valuations available at the time of filing this statement, and a projection based on experience within the same jurisdiction and other demonstrable factors, is estimated to be $60.00 per $100,000 of assessed valuation first occurring in fiscal year 2033-34.

3. The best estimate from official sources of the total debt service, including the principal and interest, that would be required to be repaid if all the bonds are issued and sold is **$713,620,521.**

Voters should note that the estimated tax rate is based on the ASSESSED VALUE of taxable property on the Riverside County official tax rolls, not on the property's market value. Property owners should consult their own property tax bills to determine their property's assessed value and any applicable tax exemptions.

Attention of all voters is directed to the fact that the foregoing information is based upon the District's projections and estimates only, which are not binding upon the District. The actual tax rates, debt service and the years in which they will apply may vary from those presently estimated, due to variations from these estimates in the timing of bond sales, the amount of bonds sold and market interest rates at the time of each sale, and actual assessed valuations over the term of repayment of the bonds. The dates of sale and the amount of bonds sold at any given time will be determined by the District based on need for construction funds and other factors. The actual interest rates at which the bonds will be sold will depend on the bond market at the time of each sale. Actual future assessed valuation will depend upon the amount and value of taxable property within the District as determined by the County Assessor in the annual assessment and the equalization process.

MURRIETA VALLEY UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

By: _____

Ward Andrus, Ed.D., Superintendent

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE "M"

The purpose of Measure M is to enable voters to authorize or reject the Murrieta Valley Unified School District ("District") issuing and selling bonds to provide financing for school facilities projects. The Board of Education of the District, by adopting Resolution No. 25/26-18 ("Resolution"), elected to call an election to place this Measure on the ballot.

Measure M would enable the District to issue and sell bonds of up to a maximum of three hundred fifty-nine million ($359,000,000), at interest rates not to exceed legal limits. Money raised by the sale of the bonds must be used exclusively to finance the list of projects described in the full text of Measure M, which is included in this voter information pamphlet ("Bond Project List"). Bond proceeds will be expended on improvements of deteriorating roofs; plumbing; HVAC; electrical; safety systems; repair/upgrade aging classrooms; science labs; career technology; and school facilities that support college/career readiness in math, science, technology, arts, engineering, and skilled trades. Monies generated by the sale of such bonds shall only be spent for these specified purposes. Bond proceeds cannot be expended to finance teacher and administrator salaries or other school operating expenses.

The bonds would be repaid through an increase in property taxes based upon the assessed value of taxable property in the District in each year of repayment. The Tax Rate Statement, which appears following the full text of Measure M in this voter information pamphlet, reflects the District's current best estimate of the property tax rate increases that will be required to service the bonds at various points during the life of the bonds. At the time of issuance, the projected annual tax to be levied to meet debt service requirements for the proposed bonds is 6¢ per $100 (or $60 per $100,000) of assessed value.

Measure M provides for the District to establish an independent citizens' oversight committee to ensure bonds proceeds are expended only on the types of school facilities projects that have been listed on the Bond Project List. The District will conduct an annual, independent performance and financial audits to oversee that bond proceeds have been expended only on the school facilities projects listed.

For this Measure to be approved, at least 55% of qualified voters within the District who vote on the Measure must vote yes.

A "YES" vote on Measure "M" is a vote to authorize the District to issue and sell bonds to provide financing of school facilities projects.

A "NO" VOTE on Measure "M" is a vote to reject the District from issuing and selling bonds to provide financing of school facilities projects.

By: Minh C. Tran
Riverside County Counsel

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "M"

Vote YES on Measure M to protect the quality of Murrieta schools—**without increasing taxes!**

Murrieta schools consistently rank among the best in the state and were recently recognized as the best in Riverside County. However, many neighborhood schools are nearly 40 years old, with "temporary" portable classrooms now more than 30 years old. Aging roofs, deteriorating plumbing, outdated classrooms and labs are in urgent need of repair and modernization.

Classrooms and schoolyards get uncomfortably hot. Updated shade structures, ventilation and air conditioning are needed for safe and healthy learning environments.

Measure M will modernize neighborhood schools to support high student achievement and serve our community for decades. Strong schools strengthen our community and protect property values.

Vote YES on M:

- Repair or replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, gas, sewer and electrical systems
- Modernize classrooms and laboratories to support high-quality instruction in science, technology, engineering and math
- Upgrade career technical education facilities and equipment to prepare students for college and in-demand careers
- Meet modern safety codes and ensure access for students with disabilities
- Repair or replace failing heating, ventilation, and air conditioning units

Measure M ensures taxpayer accountability:

- Local Control — Every dollar stays in Murrieta schools and cannot be taken by the state
- Independent Accountability — Citizens' Oversight, annual audits, public disclosure and detailed project lists ensure funds are spent as promised
- Dedicated Funding — All funds are dedicated exclusively to improving school facilities, not administrators' salaries or pensions

Measure M will not increase tax rates; it simply renews our community's commitment to excellent public schools.

Previous generations built these schools for today's students. It is now our turn to ensure the next generation inherits quality schools, not deferred maintenance bills.

Join educators, public safety officials, community members and parents. Vote YES on Measure M to protect quality education for every Murrieta student.

By: Craig Carper
Eleanor Briggs
Coley Candaele,
MVUSD Football, Track Coach
Dr. Lisa DeForest
Nicolas Pardue,
MVUSD Board President and Retired US Army Veteran

REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "M"

DO NOT BE MISLED: MEASURE M IS A NEW TAX.

Proponents say Measure M "will not increase tax rates." ***Yeah, right!***

Murrieta taxpayers already pay substantial taxes on **previously approved bond,** which voters authorized for the life of *that* bond – not permanently! As the bond is paid off, its tax burden should decline and ultimately end.

MVUSD now proposes to **backfill declining payments with the new bond.** That is not "no new tax." It is **new debt, new interest, and new 30-year obligation.**

And cost is substantial: approximately **$714 million total repayment – nearly twice the $359 million borrowed.** This means whopping **50%** of what families pay will go directly to investors**.** The claim that *"every dollar stays in Murrieta…"* is FALSE. This inconvenient truth was deliberately omitted from the ballot, despite appeals for complete transparency.

Measure M is **not** the only option for improving facilities. MVUSD maintains **$130 million General Fund balance** that may legally be used for construction and modernization. Instead of prioritizing needs, **85%** of the budget ($356 million in 2026-2027) is devoted to salaries and benefits.

Promised *"audits"* are nothing extraordinary. While necessary, those audits do **not** determine whether costs are reasonable, contracts are competitively priced, or taxpayer dollars are being spent efficiently.

Everyone supports modern classrooms. The real question is whether Murrieta families should bear heavier tax burden before the District demonstrates fiscal discipline, prioritizes resources, and starts coming clean about the true long-term cost!

VOTE NO ON MEASURE M

By: David Marko,
Inland Region Vice Chair, California Republican Party
Bob Kowell,
President, Murrieta Temecula Republican Assembly
Jack M. Guerrero, CPA
Treasurer, California Republican Party
John Leonard,
Murrieta Parent, Home owner

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE "M"

Vote NO on Measure M: This measure uses deceptive ballot language to deliberately hide the true costs from voters, rewards a blatant lack of fiscal discipline, and asks taxpayers to shoulder an even heavier financial burden despite rising cost-of-living.

1. Deceptive and Unacceptable Lack of Transparency

The ballot prominently highlights a $359 million loan but completely buries the actual repayment cost of **$714 million** (nearly double the bond issuance!) over 30 years of crushing interest. MVUSD actively withheld this information from the ballot statement because it knows voters would reject it. This intentional lack of disclosure is completely unacceptable.

2. Rewarding Fiscal Mismanagement

MVUSD's massive $356 million annual budget (2026-2027) allocates a staggering 85% for salaries and benefits. While student enrollment steadily drops, compensation keeps skyrocketing each year. **This is the height of gall.**

MVUSD is treating homeowners like an endless ATM, while holding approximately $130 million in General Fund balance (6/30/26) that state law allows for use on repairs and modernization. Furthermore, Murrieta taxpayers are *still* paying off a previously depleted MVUSD bond with one of the highest tax rates in Riverside County.

3. Extravagant Taxation Without Justification

Murrieta families shoulder one of the highest tax burdens in America. Nearly half (45%) of local property tax already funds public education, while California pours a massive $20,000 per student into schools. With costs of housing, groceries, insurance, and utilities at historic highs, asking homeowners for another tax is completely out of touch.

Conclusion: No Accountability, No New Taxes

True support for our schools requires accountability, responsible budgeting, and total honesty. MVUSD has proven it lacks fiscal discipline, refuses to control spending, and cannot be trusted to be fully transparent with our community. **Vote NO on Measure M.**

By: Carl DeMaio,
Chairman, Reform California

Bob Kowell,
President, Murrieta Temecula Republican Assembly

John Leonard,
Murrieta Parent/Homeowner

Jack M. Guerrero, CPA
Treasurer, California Republican Party

Rick Gibbs,
Former Mayor, City of Murrieta

REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE "M"

Measure M advances responsible stewardship of our community's schools without **increasing tax rates.** The argument against Measure M misrepresents how California school finance works.

Excellent students deserve excellent schools. Our community benefits from the highest-performing schools in Riverside County. Measure M ensures our school facilities reflect that same standard of excellence our students achieve today and for future generations.

Delaying necessary improvements doesn't eliminate costs. It increases future repair costs for taxpayers and students. Addressing these needs now is the fiscally responsible choice.

Measure M invests in school facilities, not operating expenses. Measure M funds cannot be used for administrators' salaries, pensions or daily operating expenses. By law, they are restricted to voter-approved school facilities and infrastructure.

District operating reserves are not a substitute for long-term facility improvements. Responsible reserves protect students during emergencies and economic uncertainty, while bond funding repairs roofs, plumbing, electrical and HVAC equipment, and modernizes classrooms and security systems.

Measure M was developed *by* our community, *for* our community, through a transparent, year-long planning process that included more than 80 public meetings, 13 facilities focus groups, 3 town halls, 2 community facilities advisory meetings and numerous public Board meetings. Learn more at: https://www.mvusdplan.org.

Measure M guarantees taxpayer protections through fiscal accountability and transparency. Every dollar stays under local control and cannot be taken by the state. Independent citizens' oversight, annual audits, detailed project lists and public disclosure ensure funds are spent as promised.

Measure M - The responsible choice for Murrieta.
Vote YES on Measure M.

By: Vincent Murray,
Citizens Oversight Vice Chair, Retired US Military

Anthony Conrad,
Retired Murrieta Police Chief

Nancy Young,
MVUSD Board Member and Retired Teacher

Elliot Emmer,
MVUSD School Board Member

Paul Parker,
Chairman, Citizens Oversight Committee